

PEOPLE'S VICTORY

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With international criticism of the Emergency mounting and its author, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi under increasing pressure, she advised the President to dissolve the Lok Sabha and order fresh elections. The resulting poll in 1977 saw her Congress party badly mauled and the country got its first non-Congress government in 30 years, led by Morarji Desai of the Janata Party. Mrs Gandhi lost her own seat in her stronghold of Rae Bareilly and the Congress strength in the Lok Sabha shrunk from 350 to 153. The party failed to win a single seat in Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Punjab, Haryana and Delhi. The new government set up the Shah Commission to probe into Emergency excesses, indicting many senior Congress leaders.

FIRST CUT

- Meher Moos became the first woman to reach Antarctica.
- Michael Ferreira became the first Indian to win both the World Amateur and the Open

Billiards Championship held in Melbourne.

- Saudi Arabia extended its first ever loan to India. The loan, meant for two power projects, totalled Rs 10 crore.

SOUTHERN RUIN

A cyclone in Andhra Pradesh killed over 35,000 people and two to three lakh animals. Lakhs were left homeless.



DRAMA OF DECADENCE

Satyajit Ray's first step into Hindi films, *Shatranj Ke Khiladi*, with its star cast of Sanjeev Kumar, Saeed Jaffrey, Amjad Khan and Shabana Azmi, was also one of his most expensive. Based on a story by Premchand that revolves around two chess players, and set in 19th-century aristocratic Lucknow, it mocked the apathy of the upper class.



<< DID YOU KNOW

Two hundred and fifty "notorious smugglers" like Yusuf Patel, Haji Mastan and Sukarnarain Bakhia took a pledge before Jayaprakash Narayan in Bombay to renounce smuggling.